The groove cut on the shaft and the groove cut inside the pulleys, gears and flange. Which is parallel to their axis then it is called "key way".

Types of Key

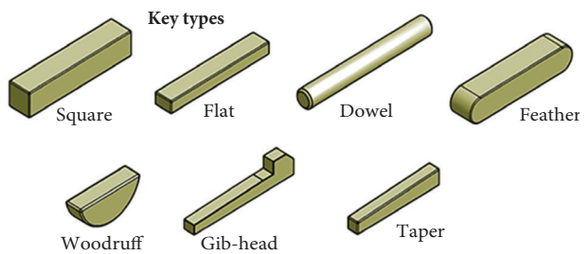
1. Sunk Key
2. Saddle Key
3. Round Key

Sunk Key

This is a standard form of key and it may be either rectangular or square in cross section. The two ends of the key may be square or round.

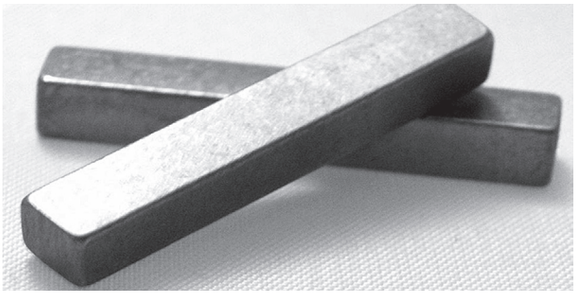
Types of Sunk Keys:

1. Parallel Key
2. Tapper Key
3. Gib Headed Key
4. Feather Key
5. Wood-Ruff Key



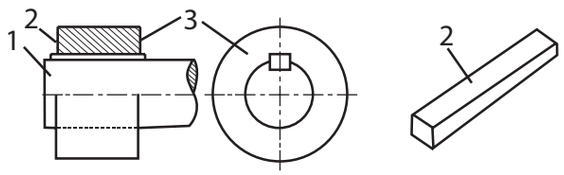
Types of Sunk Keys

Parallel Key: A parallel key is rectangular or square in cross-section and uniform in width and thickness, throughout its length. These keys are generally used where pulleys, gears or other similar parts are secured to the shaft permitting relative axial movement.



Parallel Key

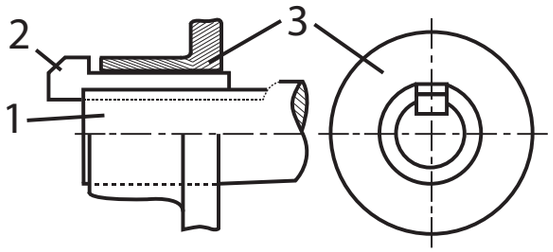
Taper Key: A taper key is uniform in width but tapered in thickness. The bottom surface of the key is flatted and the top surface is tapered. The magnitude of the taper is 1:100.



1. Shaft. 2. Tapper Key 3. Hub

Taper Key

Gib Headed Key: A taper key is generally removed by hammering at its thinner end, when that end is inaccessible. The key is usually provided with a head called gib-head which enable to remove the key. This type of key is used when the connected parts are to be separated occasionally for the purpose of repair.



1. Shaft. 2. Gib headed Key 3. Hub

Gib Headed Key

Feather Key: A Feather key is attached to one member of the pair, screwed to the shaft. Feather keys are parallel keys

BME_Chp07.indd 93 11/9/2020 12:24:38 PM